time away from India. Even the local chief told 18-year-old Gandhi that if he left home, he would be banished from his caste. Unconcerned, Mohandas made the journey to London and accepted his enrollment at London's University College.

The young student had promised his family that he would continue to abstain from alcohol, meat, and extramarital affairs, and this was a promise he took seriously. Unfortunately, he found very little to eat in London that suited his vegetarian diet. Eventually, he found a lonely vegetarian restaurant in the city and befriended many of its patrons, who elected him an executive member of the Vegetarian Society. It was this society that turned Mohandas' social life around, as he met many Hindus, Buddhists, and theological philosophers with whom he could discuss his own beliefs and hopes for the future.

Having earned his law degree and passed the necessary exams to establish a practice of his own, Gandhi left London at age 22 to discover the devastating news that during his studies, his mother had passed away. After several years of struggling to set up a law office in India, the young man accepted a legal position in the Colony of Natal, South Africa. He set sail in 1893 alone, expecting to work in Natal for about one year.

The blatant racism Gandhi experienced in South Africa, then a British colony, was not only humiliating but politically eye-opening. Mohandas believed himself to be a British citizen equal to those in any other colony, but outside of India, it became clear that white British citizens held themselves above others. Non-whites were denied seats on the bus, expected not to mix with white people, and generally harassed and beaten for a plethora of supposed indiscretions that may or may not have been imagined. Perplexed and disoriented, Mohandas completed the legal project he'd been recruited for and made plans to return to India—he didn't follow through on those plans. Instead, he merely collected his family and headed back to the Colony of Natal, inspired to help the Indians there with much-needed legal reform.

Though at first, Gandhi was singularly focused on the plight of Indians in Natal, he eventually extended that empathy to the oppressed native black people of South Africa. By the time the British Empire declared war on the Zulu Kingdom in 1906, Mohandas had realized that it was not only his own people who had been pressed under the heel of Great Britain. To demonstrate solidarity between Indians and Africans, Gandhi organized a